Where You Are: Naming the Care Problems, and What Comes After

All nine steps of the Family Care Roadmap, and the one you're standing on.

When a parent's care isn't working, it can feel as if the family has to fix all of it this week. It doesn't. There is an order to this, and naming the problems comes near the very start.

This page lays out the whole road, shows where you are on it, and says what follows.

Phase 1 · Care Assessment

Understand the person, the family, and the situation.

1 **Discover** Current Situation → Concerns & Challenges → Goals & Priorities
You finish with: Family Discovery Summary

You are here. Your part of this step right now is its middle topic, the concerns and challenges. You finish it with the main concerns written down with an example for each, what your sister needs in plain view, and a next contact or action beside each pressing issue.

2 **Assess** Health & Function → Safety & Support → Lifestyle & Preferences
You finish with: Personal Care Assessment Summary

3 **Define Needs** Needs & Risks → Care Requirements → Priorities & Recommendations
You finish with: Care Needs Profile and Immediate Action Roadmap

Phase 2 · Care Planning

Determine what good care should look like and prepare to put it in place.

4 **Explore Options** Care Setting → Provider/Facility Fit → Selection & Decision
You finish with: Care Options Comparison and Decision Record

5 **Build the Plan** Health & Personal Care → Daily Life & Quality of Life → Monitoring & Response
You finish with: Personal Care Proposal, Good Day Plan, and Monitoring Plan

6 **Prepare the Transition** Preparation → Move & Admission → Continuity of Care
You finish with: Transition Preparation Pack and Confirmed Handoff Log

Phase 3 · Care Management

Coordinate the plan, review what happens, and prepare the family to take the lead.

7 **Coordinate** People & Responsibilities → Communication & Handoffs → Care-Plan Alignment
You finish with: Care Team Plan and Care-Plan Alignment Record

8 **Monitor** Monitor → Identify & Escalate → Review & Adjust
You finish with: Care Review Dashboard and Concern/Change Logs

9 **Hand Off** Educate → Empower → Support
You finish with: Family Care Management Playbook and Handoff/Support Plan

What this step produces

A short written list of what is going wrong with your father's care: each concern with an example, the tasks that aren't getting done, what your sister needs now, and who should hear about each one. It is a family's list, organized. It isn't a finding about anyone, and it doesn't decide anything.

What happens next

One more topic finishes this step: what matters most to your father and to the family in the decisions ahead. Your list of concerns is part of what that conversation starts from. After that, the step called Assess looks at your father's health and daily function, his safety and support, and how he likes to live.

The list doesn't have to be complete before you move on. The Family Caregiver Alliance reminds families that a family meeting is not a one-time event; what isn't settled stays on the list. [2]

Where the health questions go

Concerns about your father's health travel a different road from the family's own questions. The National Institute on Aging suggests making a list of the questions and concerns you want to bring up with the doctor and bringing it to the appointment, starting with the most important ones. [1]

Who is involved, by role

- You and your family: naming the concerns, finding an example for each, writing them down.
- Your father: his own account of what is working and what isn't, and what he wants.
- Your sister, as the person doing most of the day-to-day: what she handles, and what cannot go on as it is.
- His clinicians (doctor, nurse, pharmacist): the questions about his health and his medications, and what anything means medically.
- Your care consultant: the person who can bring caregiver strain, family disagreement and unmet tasks into one conversation and look at what each one calls for.

What this page doesn't promise

How long a step takes, who will be available, or how any conversation turns out. Every family travels this road at its own pace.

Ready for the next step?

You know where this step sits and what follows it. The care interview is how you finish it: it asks about your father's daily life and the care around him in a set order and turns your answers into a Family Care Profile you can bring to any care conversation.

Create Your Free Family Care Profile ›

WHERE THIS COMES FROM

The nine steps are the Family Care Roadmap's own. The advice about bringing a written list to the doctor is the National Institute on Aging's, and the reminder that a family meeting is not a one-time event is the Family Caregiver Alliance's.

1. National Institute on Aging, Taking Someone to a Doctor's Appointment: Tips for Caregivers
2. Family Caregiver Alliance, Holding a Family Meeting